# Financial research with AI

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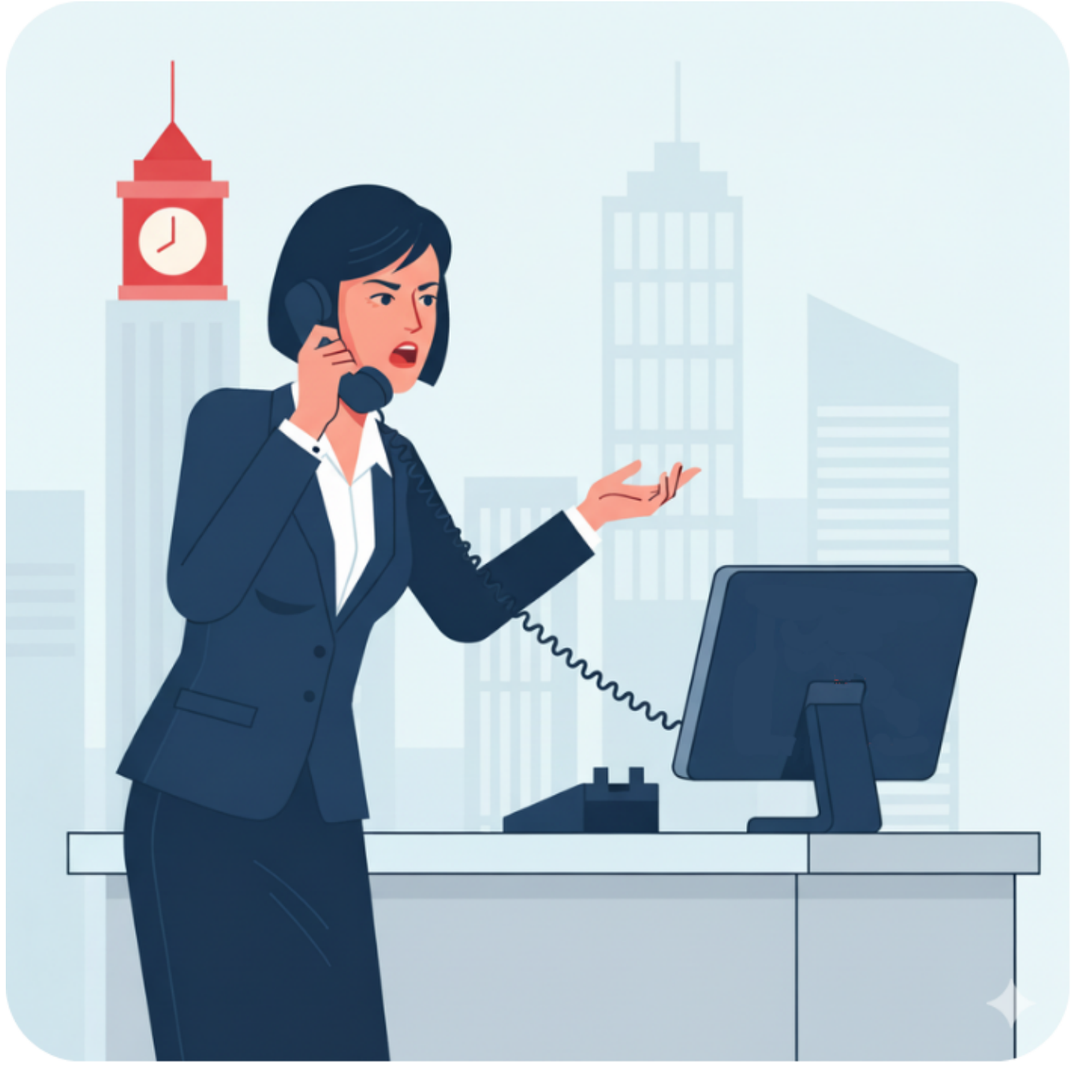


**Glenn Hopper**
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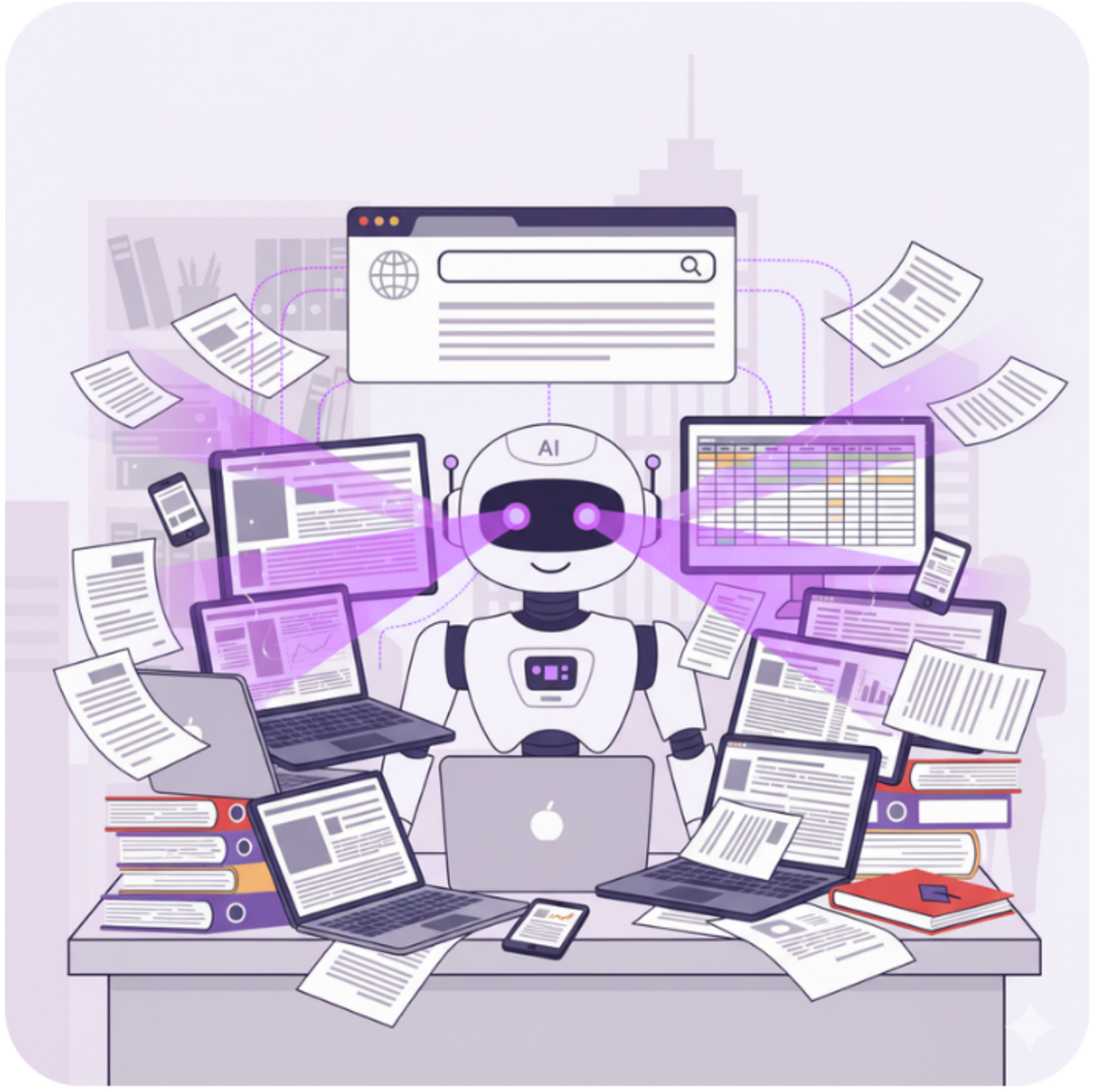
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# The CFO's question



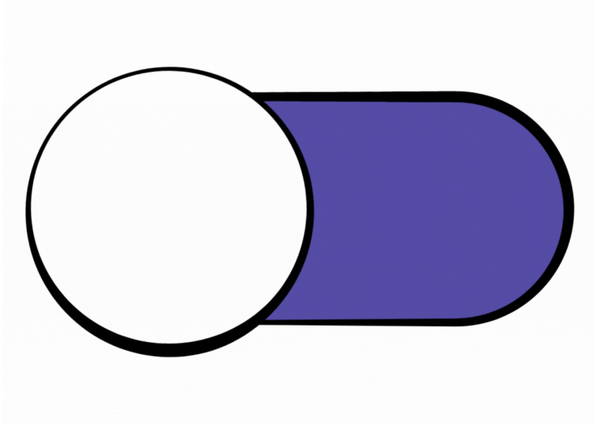



AI

# AI online

**Web-enabled AI models can access:**

- Official statements
- Market news
- Analyst notes
- Economic data

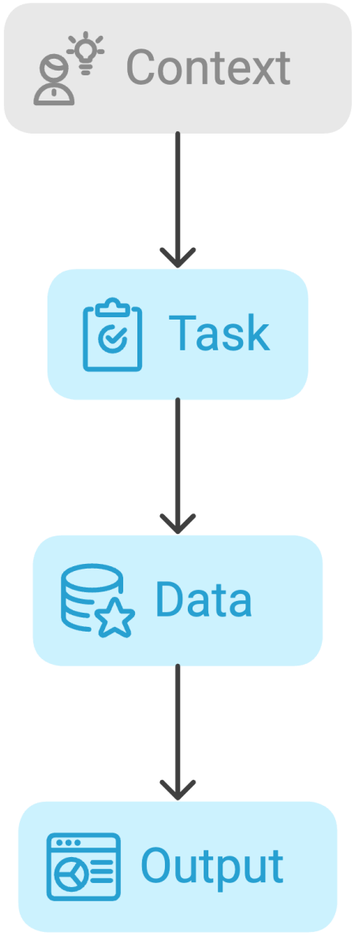


**Connecting perspectives:**

- Links insights across multiple viewpoints
- Builds balanced, big-picture context

**Your role in framing:**

- The AI finds patterns
- You decide what to focus on


Context
Task
Data
Output

# STOA



**Assumptions**

Identifies the underlying beliefs of the research

**Timeframe**

Sets the duration for the research

**Output**

Specifies the deliverables of the research

**Scope**

Defines the boundaries of the research

# Prompting with STOA

## Scope

- Define what you want to cover
- *Federal Reserve interest-rate decision*

## Timeframe

- Anchor the analysis in time
- *Most recent decision*

## Output

- Specify the desired format or focus
- *Summarize... three bullet points*

## Assumptions

- Add any context or limits
- *Assume current macro conditions*

> **Summarize** the **most recent Federal Reserve interest rate decision** and outline its short-term and long-term impact on equity and credit markets. **Assume current macro conditions** and present the insights in **three bullet points**.

# Always verify



Check provided citations for:

- Accuracy
- Timeliness
- Consistency
- Contradictions

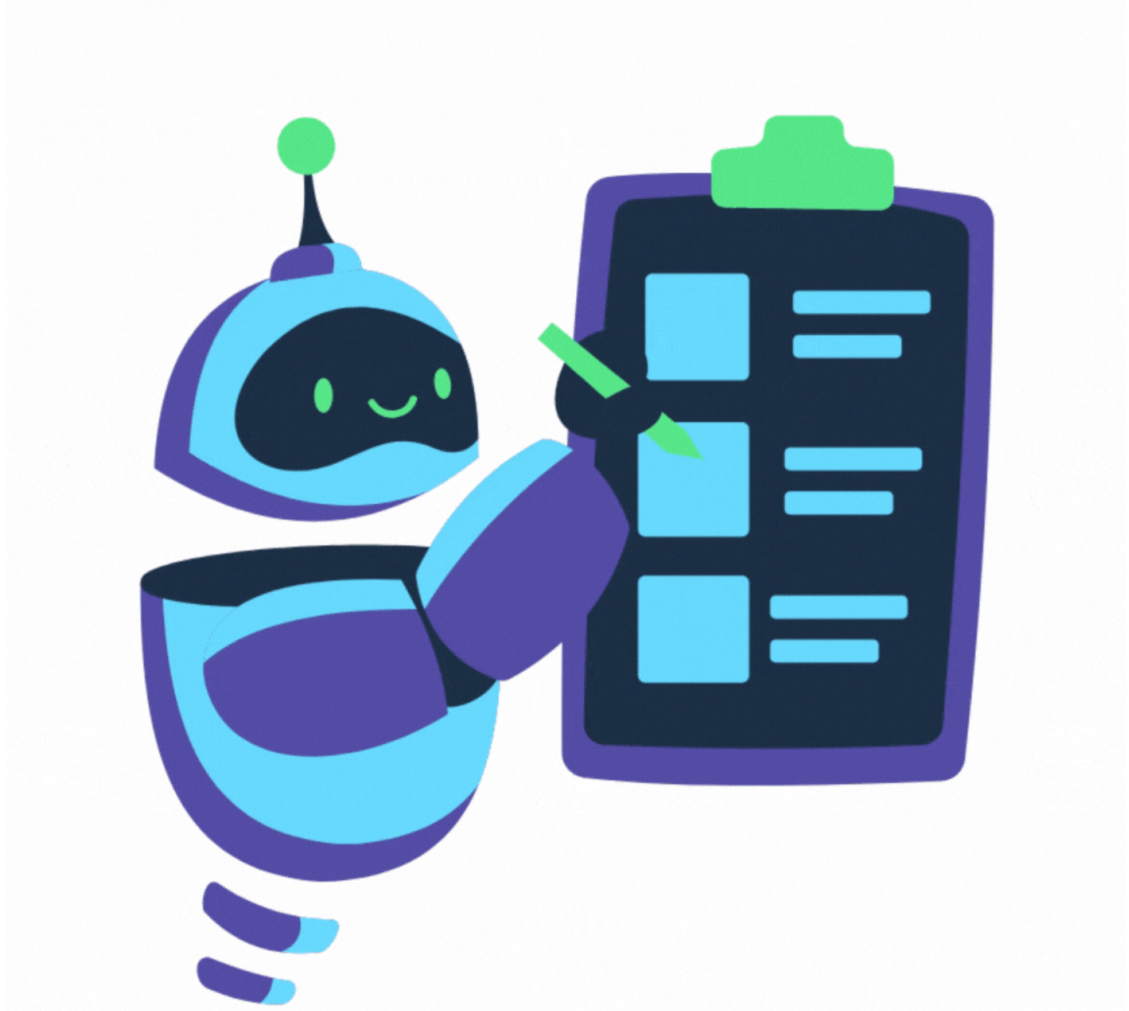
# So what?

- Identify two or three key drivers and translate them into a one-sentence "so what"

- Use this pattern: Because `cause`, we expect `effect`, which implies `action` for `team or KPI`

**Example**: Because `rates remain high`, we expect `higher borrowing costs` and will `review` our `cash-flow forecasts`.

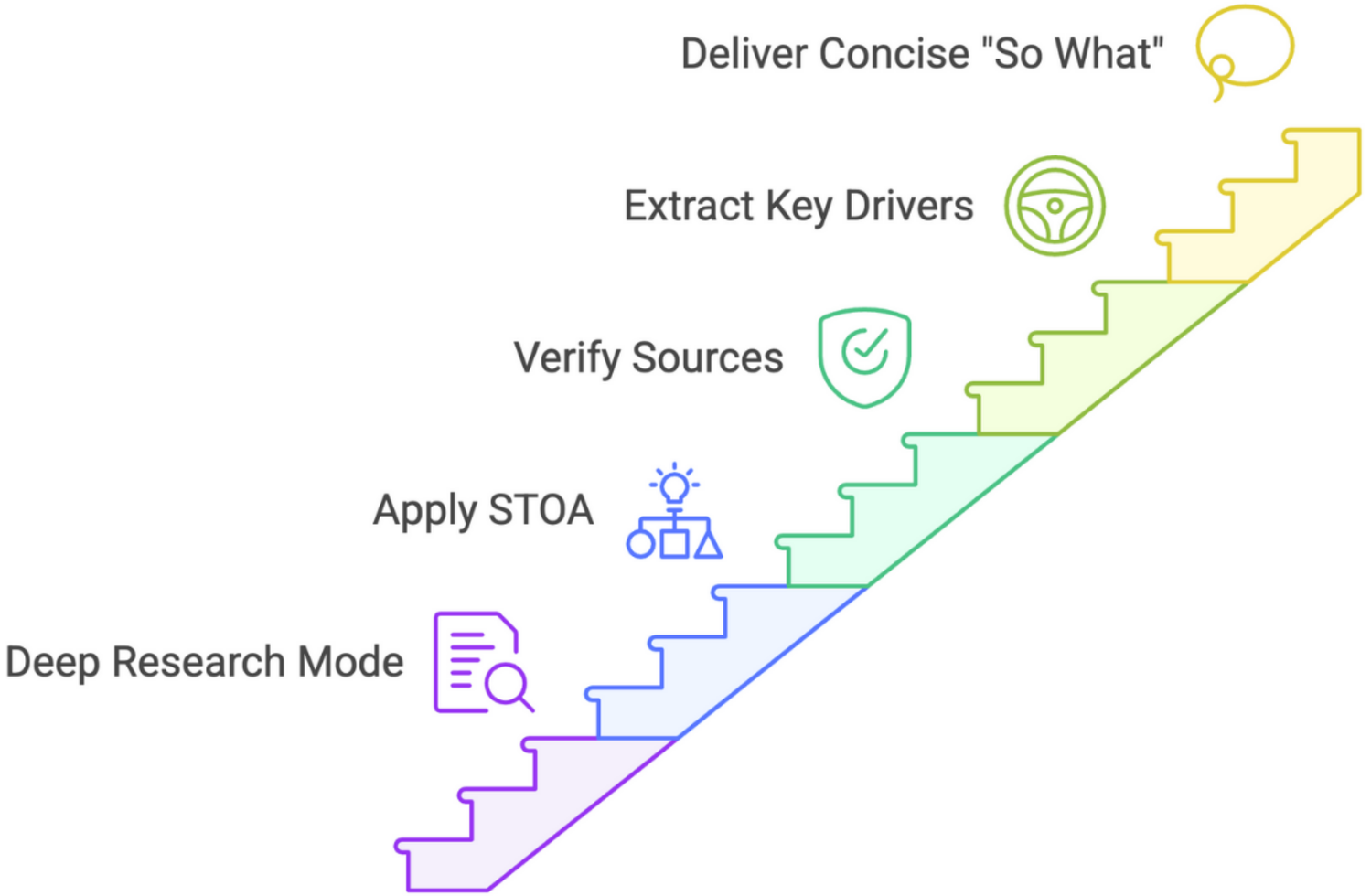
# Quick credibility checklist



- Are there at least two citations?
- Are dates current?
- Is the tone factual?
- Do sources align?
- Is your takeaway business-specific?

If not, **refine** and **recheck**

# Research to insight



# Let's practice!

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# Driving tailored output with custom instructions

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# Starting from scratch

### Company Filing Summary: Galactic Enterprises, Inc.

| Field | Detail |
|---|---|
| **Filing Form** | Form 8-K: Material Event Disclosure |
| **Company (Acquirer)** | Galactic Enterprises, Inc. (GEI) |
| **Acquired Entity** | Astro-Mining Consortium (AMC) |
| **Nature of Transaction** | All-cash acquisition of all outstanding shares. |
| **Transaction Value** | $\500 Billion Galactic Credits (GC) |
| **Premium Paid** | 40<br>over last internal valuation. |
| **Funding Source** | Existing capital reserves & 2.5<br>Perpetual Zero-Coupon Cosmic Bonds. |
| **Strategic Rationale** | Securing Xenon-3 isotope supply chain for hyper-drive stabilizers. |
| **Expected Cost Reduction** | 30<br>in production costs within the next fiscal cycle. |
| **Projected Revenue Impact** | 15<br>increase in quarterly revenue post-closure. |
| **Expected Closing Date** | First solar quarter of 2743. |

Export to Sheets

Enter a prompt for Gemini

Tools

### Galactic Enterprises, Inc. - Form 8-K: Acquisition of Astro-Mining Consortium

**FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE**

**Aether City, Terra Nova – October 13, 2742** – Galactic Enterprises, Inc. (GEI), the multi-sector conglomerate known for its dominance in inter-stellar transport and atmospheric purification systems, today filed a Form 8-K with the Interplanetary Securities Exchange Commission (ISEC) announcing a definitive agreement to acquire all outstanding shares of Astro-Mining Consortium (AMC).

AMC, a privately held deep-space extraction specialist, is the leading provider of rare-earth Xenon-3 isotopes, critical for GEI's next generation of hyper-drive stabilizers.

**Transaction Details:** The all-cash transaction is valued at $\500 billion Galactic Credits (GC), representing a 40
premium over AMC's last internal valuation. Funding will be sourced from GEI's existing capital reserves and a newly issued tranche of 2.5
perpetual zero-coupon cosmic bonds.

**Strategic Rationale:** CEO Kaelen Varr stated, "This acquisition is a pivotal step in securing our supply chain and solidifying GEI's position as the sole provider of interstellar travel solutions in the Perseus Arm. Integrating AMC's advanced asteroid-harvesting technology will reduce our production costs by an estimated 30
within the next fiscal cycle."

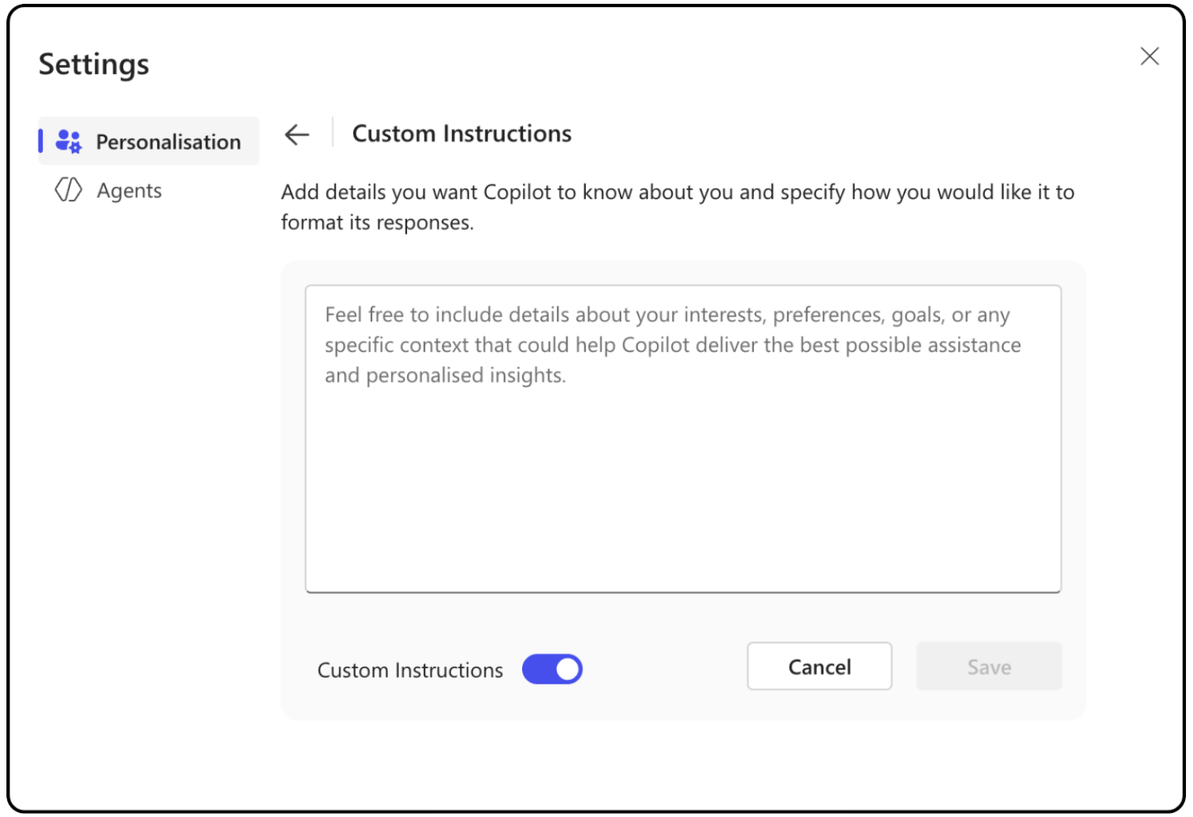
Enter a prompt for Gemini

Tools

# What are custom instructions?

Persistent rules that guide every AI response

- Remembers your task, tone, and format preferences
- Acts like a personal analyst brief for each chat
- Keeps finance outputs consistent in style and sourcing



# Example

```
Always summarize companies in a table format with two columns.
Include key metrics and cite at least one source for each figure.
```

## Without custom instructions

**Company Name:** SolaraTech Ltd.
**Industry:** Renewable Energy
**Fiscal Year Ended:** 30 September 2025

### 📊 Financial Highlights

- **Revenue:** £128.4 million
  Up 18% year-over-year, driven by strong demand for solar panel installations across Europe and new government subsidies in the UK and Germany.
- **Operating Profit:** £21.7 million
  Margins improved to 16.9% due to operational efficiencies and reduced supply chain costs.
- **Net Income:** £15.2 million
  A 24% increase from the previous year, reflecting both revenue growth and disciplined cost management.
- **Earnings Per Share (EPS):** £0.38
  Compared to £0.31 in FY2024.
- **Cash Reserves:** £42.6 million
  Strengthened by improved collections and a reduction in capital expenditures.

Message Copilot

Researcher

## With custom instructions

### SolaraTech Ltd. – FY2025 Financial Summary

| Metric | Value & Commentary |
|---|---|
| **Revenue** | £128.4 million 📈 +18% YoY growth, driven by strong solar panel demand and subsidies. |
| **Operating Profit** | £21.7 million 💼 Margin improved to 16.9% due to efficiency gains and lower costs. |
| **Net Income** | £15.2 million 💰 Up 24% YoY, reflecting disciplined cost control and revenue growth. |
| **Earnings Per Share** | £0.38 🧾 Compared to £0.31 in FY2024. |
| **Cash Reserves** | £42.6 million 🏦 Boosted by better collections and reduced capital spending. |

**Source:** Internal company data (fictional)

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Researcher

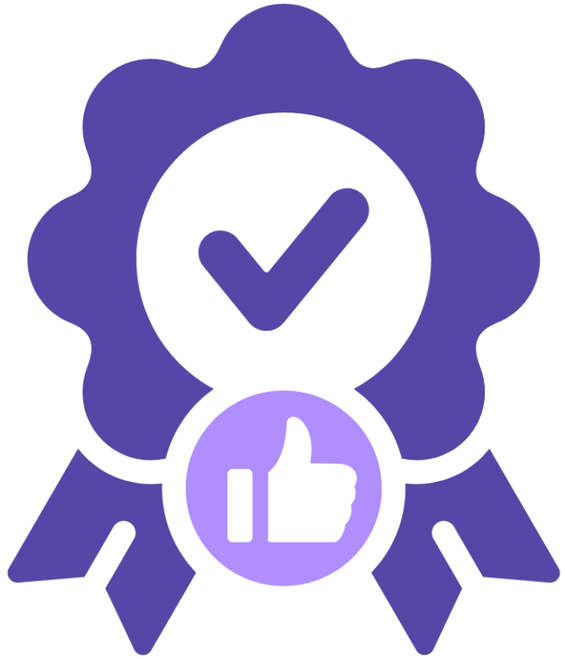
# Tips for writing instructions




- Consistency builds trust
- Writing effective instructions:
  - Keep them short, clear, and professional
  - Use action verbs: compare, cite, summarize, format
  - Avoid emotional or subjective language
- Keep them evolving

# Prompts with parameters

- **Web-enabled AI** gives you access to real-time data
- **Custom instructions** let you shape how that data is processed and presented



**Faster**, **cleaner**, more **credible** outputs every time

# Let's practice!

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# Keep up with scheduled prompts

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# The 4:00 PM ping



# The challenge

- Tracking ESG and regulatory updates is time-consuming and fragmented
- Missing one can affect disclosure planning or sustainability reporting



# Introducing scheduled prompts

**Why scheduling matters:**

- Turns one-time prompts into recurring updates
- Keeps finance teams current on ESG and regulatory changes
- Automates refreshes so summaries stay up to date
- Improves compliance visibility and reduces last-minute research

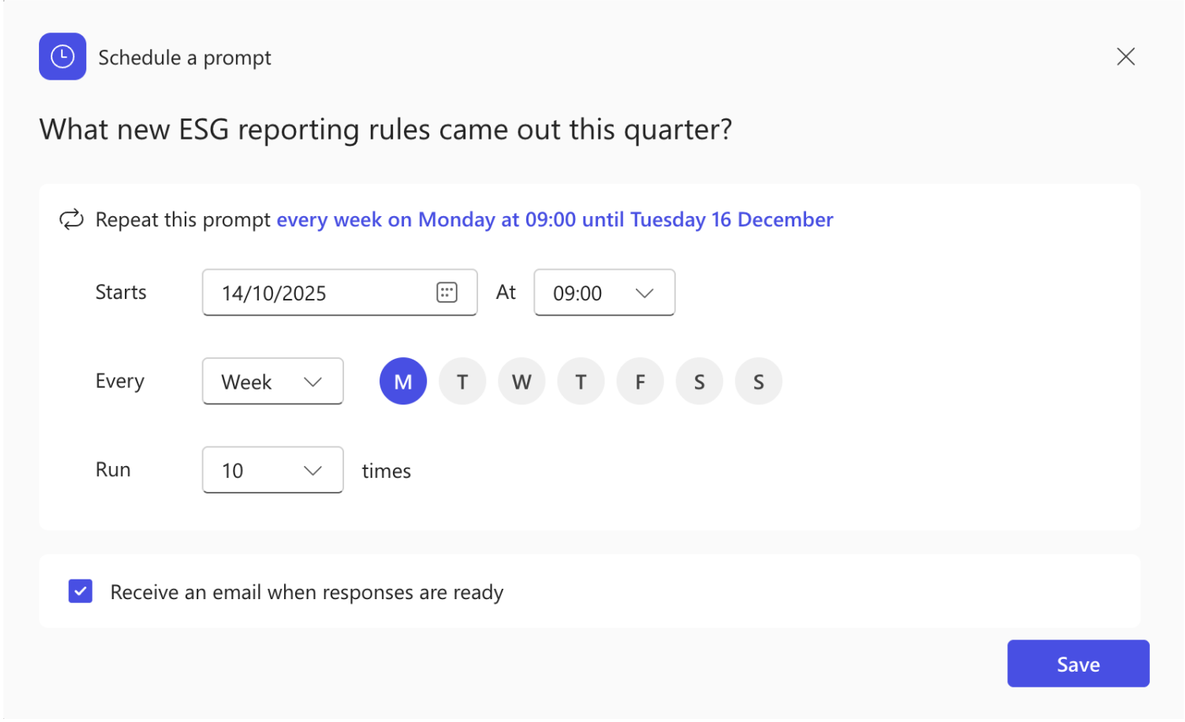
**How to apply scheduling:**

- Schedule weekly ESG or policy updates
- Run monthly tax or disclosure summaries
- Check quarterly accounting or audit changes
- Build a reliable cadence for timely leadership insights

# Stay ahead

## Scheduling across AI tools

- Most AI tools support scheduling or reminders, built in or via automation apps
- Instead of remembering weekly prompts, let AI run them for you

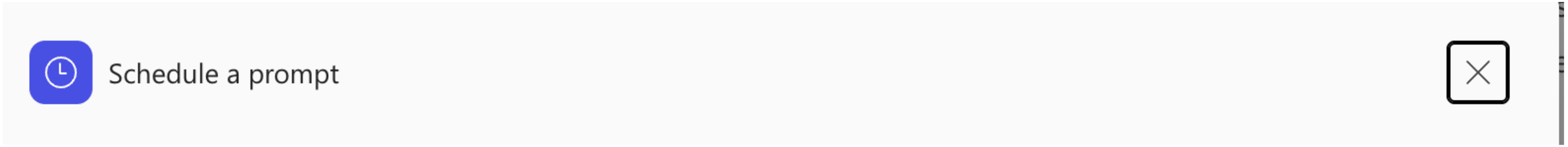


# Example

1. Prepare prompt

```
Summarize any new SEC or EU ESG reporting rules this week.
Provide three bullet points with impact levels (Low, Medium, High).
Include sources.
```

2. Set schedule



## SEC (U.S.)

- **SEC signals reevaluation of ESG-related shareholder proposals**
  The SEC Chair announced plans to reassess rules requiring companies to include ESG-related shareholder proposals in proxy filings, aiming to curb what they call “politicization” of shareholder meetings. This could significantly reduce investor influence on corporate ESG agendas.
  **Impact: High** – Potentially reshapes corporate governance and ESG advocacy in U.S. markets.
  Source bloomberglaw

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## EU

- **EU Parliament backs major cuts to Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD)**
  Legal Affairs Committee approved raising thresholds to 5,000 employees and €1.5B turnover, and dropping mandatory climate transition plans. This dramatically narrows the scope of due diligence obligations.
  **Impact: High** – Exempts thousands of companies, reducing compliance costs but weakening ESG accountability.
  Source msn
- **EU business leaders push for full repeal of CS3D rules**
  46 CEOs from major firms (e.g., Siemens, TotalEnergies) urged Macron and Merz to abolish CS3D entirely, citing competitiveness concerns. While repeal is unlikely, pressure may accelerate simplification efforts.
  **Impact: Medium** – Signals strong corporate resistance; could influence final legislative compromise.
  Source forbes

# Good practices

- Start small
- Verify sources
- Use effective prompting techniques
  - Concise, clear, and time-bound
  - Use a neutral tones; avoid policy interpretation
- Store reports in a shared folder for transparency
- Review schedules regularly to keep them relevant
- Combine with custom instructions



# Let's practice!

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